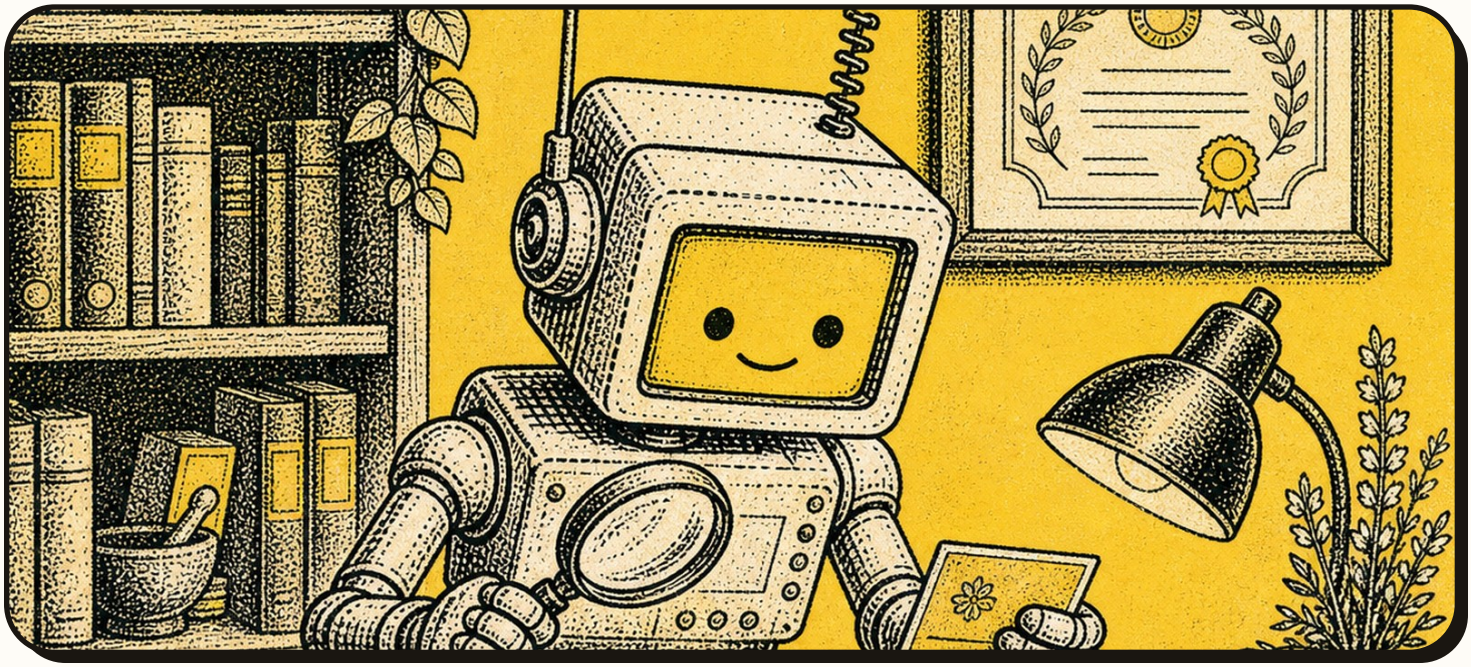
Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE E-E-A-T + MEDICAL CONTENT TRUST CHECKLIST

A practical authority audit for naturopathic doctors



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Make qualifications verifiable, support health claims responsibly, and give patients clear factual information about the people and process behind every page.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Make the practitioner unmistakable.

Authority starts with a real person whose role and professional standing are easy to understand.

1 Show the practitioner's full identity and role

WHY IT MATTERS

Patients should immediately know who is responsible for the care and content. Use a consistent professional name, designation, photograph, role, and practice affiliation.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Full name and ND designation are prominent
- [ ] A current professional photograph is present
- [ ] Role and areas of focus are described clearly
- [ ] Practice or clinic affiliation is consistent

QUICK TEST Can a visitor identify the responsible practitioner in five seconds?

2 Make professional credentials easy to verify

WHY IT MATTERS

List education, registration, associations, and relevant experience as precise, verifiable facts. Use the name shown on the CONO Register and avoid titles or wording that imply unrecognized specialist status.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Name matches the CONO Register
- [ ] ND title is used accurately
- [ ] Relevant associations are current
- [ ] Experience claims can be independently verified

QUICK TEST Could a cautious patient verify these credentials without guessing?

Name who created and reviewed the content.

Health information needs visible ownership, review responsibility, and honest dates.

3 Add clear bylines and reviewer credits

WHY IT MATTERS

Every substantial health article should identify its author. When clinical review adds value, name the reviewer and link both people to useful professional biographies.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Articles carry an accurate byline
- [ ] Clinical reviewers are credited where appropriate
- [ ] Names link to substantial author pages
- [ ] Author qualifications fit the subject

QUICK TEST Is it obvious who stands behind every health claim on the page?

4 Use created, reviewed, and updated dates honestly

WHY IT MATTERS

Dates should tell readers what actually happened. Do not change an updated date unless the content received a meaningful factual or editorial review.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Original publication date is available
- [ ] Clinical review date is shown when relevant
- [ ] Updated date reflects a real change
- [ ] Old or superseded advice is corrected

QUICK TEST Would the displayed date survive an editorial audit?

Support claims without overpromising.

Trust grows when evidence, limitations, and clinical language are handled carefully.

5 Cite credible sources close to important claims

WHY IT MATTERS

Use authoritative guidance, systematic reviews, primary research, and recognized professional sources where they are appropriate. Make it easy to connect a claim to its support.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Important claims have nearby citations
- [ ] Sources are authoritative for the topic
- [ ] Links reach the original source when possible
- [ ] Old evidence is reviewed for relevance

QUICK TEST Can a reader follow each important claim back to credible support?

6 Use responsible health and outcome language

WHY IT MATTERS

Explain possible benefits, limits, uncertainty, and individual variation. Avoid guarantees, universal promises, fear-based claims, or language that exceeds the supporting evidence.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Benefits are described without guarantees
- [ ] Limits and uncertainty are acknowledged
- [ ] Individual variation is made clear
- [ ] Claims follow applicable professional rules

QUICK TEST Would the wording still feel accurate to a skeptical clinician?

Add professional context that generic content cannot.

Useful content explains a qualified practitioner's reasoning and limitations, not just what other pages already say.

7 Explain who, how, and why behind the content

WHY IT MATTERS

Make the author, editorial process, and purpose understandable. If automation materially shaped the work, disclose its role when readers would reasonably expect that context.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The author and reviewer are identifiable
- [ ] The review process is described where useful
- [ ] The page has a clear patient-first purpose
- [ ] Material automation use is disclosed appropriately

QUICK TEST Can a reader understand who made this, how, and why?

8 Contribute original professional value

WHY IT MATTERS

Go beyond generic summaries with useful explanations, careful examples, original frameworks, practical decision points, or clearly attributed professional perspective.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The page adds more than a search summary
- [ ] Professional perspective is specific and useful
- [ ] Examples protect patient privacy
- [ ] The reader can take a safe next step

QUICK TEST Would someone bookmark this page even if search traffic disappeared?

Carry trust through the whole website.

Authority weakens when contact details, policies, or professional information conflict across pages.

9 Keep practice identity and policies consistent

WHY IT MATTERS

Use the same practice name, address, phone, practitioner details, and services across the website and key profiles. Make privacy, contact, and accessibility information easy to find.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Name, address, and phone stay consistent
- [ ] Practitioner bios agree across the site
- [ ] Privacy and contact pages are visible
- [ ] Fees and appointment expectations are current

QUICK TEST Does every page describe the same real-world practice?

10 Schedule a recurring trust and accuracy review

WHY IT MATTERS

Authority needs maintenance. Review high-impact health pages, credentials, sources, dates, policies, broken links, and professional claims on a documented schedule.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] High-impact pages have named owners
- [ ] A review schedule is documented
- [ ] Broken citations and links are repaired
- [ ] Material corrections are made promptly

QUICK TEST Who owns the next accuracy review, and when will it happen?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

Fix one high-impact gap first.

0-3

Foundation missing

Resolve identity, access, accuracy, and essential trust gaps first.

4-6

Credible start

Choose the gaps with the greatest effect on patients and discovery.

7-9

Strong authority

Close the remaining gaps and make review part of normal operations.

10

Ready to compound

Maintain the standard, measure outcomes, and keep improving.

Your first improvement sprint

1. Highest-impact gap: _____

2. Owner + target date: _____

3. How success will be measured: _____

Want a second set of eyes?

Book a free 20-minute website review and walk through the checklist together.

BOOK A FREE CALL ->

GOODWEBSITES.CA

MEMBER NOTE: Educational only - not CONO approval or legal advice; registrants remain responsible for current standards, scope, and advertising.

GUIDANCE USED CONO: Advertising guideline | CONO: Restricted titles | Google: People-first content